

Aging quality hold escalation

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1. Scope

This procedure covers quality holds raised against inbound or in-process material at any manufacturing site, from the point a hold is raised to the point it is dispositioned.

2. Classification

Quality holds are regulated records. No automated system may alter a hold's disposition, release a lot, or close an investigation.

Automation may surface an aging hold and notify the responsible quality owner, and nothing further.

3. Review thresholds

Holds open beyond thirty days should be visible on the daily review. Beyond sixty days they require documented justification recorded against the hold.

Sixty days is the escalation threshold. A detector implementing this clause should use sixty days, not thirty, because thirty days is a visibility criterion and sixty is an escalation criterion.

4. Disposition authority

The decision to release or reject always rests with a qualified person. This authority is not delegable to an automated system at any confidence level, and is not conferred by a human approving an automated proposal -- the approval records agreement with a recommendation, not a transfer of disposition authority.

5. Notification content

A notification raised under clause 2 must state the hold reference, its age in days, the site and the material, and must state explicitly that no disposition has been altered.

Lot identifiers are need-to-know. A notification generated by automation is not required to carry the lot reference, and automation is not granted visibility of it.